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Week 6, Git Hands On – 2

Objectives

- Explain git ignore
- Explain how to ignore unwanted files using git ignore

In this hands-on lab, you will learn how to:

- Implement git ignore command to ignore unwanted files and folders

Solution :

A **.gitignore** file is a special configuration file used in Git to prevent specific files and folders from being tracked and committed to a repository. It is useful for excluding unnecessary or sensitive files such as compiled code (*.class), log files (*.log), temporary files, IDE settings (like .idea/ or .vscode/), build directories (target/ or build/), and environment files containing secrets (.env). To ignore unwanted files, create a file named .gitignore in the project's root directory and list the file names, folder names, or patterns to be ignored, for example target/, *.log, or .idea/. Once configured, Git will automatically skip these untracked files when you run commands like git add ., keeping the repository clean, secure, and free of unnecessary files. Note that .gitignore only affects files that are not already being tracked by Git; if a file has already been committed, it must first be removed from Git's tracking using git rm --cached <file> before the ignore rule takes effect.

```
Windows PowerShell
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PS D:\Projects\Cognizant\git\gitDemo> echo "node_modules/" > .gitignore
PS D:\Projects\Cognizant\git\gitDemo> cat .\gitignore
node_modules/
PS D:\Projects\Cognizant\git\gitDemo> |
```

